

1.2.5.2 Positional defence

Positional defence comprises two phases: defensive organisation and the positional defence itself. Defensive organisation is the initial phase of a positional defence. It is short in duration but requires a high level of communication between defenders, together with quick and accurate analysis of the game situation. This is necessary in regaining defensive organisation, picking up opposition players, covering, and controlling the space.

The **positional defence** consists of all of the defensive movements that a team performs as soon as it organises itself defensively. The nature of these movements depends on the type of defence and defensive systems employed in each area of the court. Defensive systems are based on types of defence and core defensive technical/tactical concepts, the cornerstone of which is **marking** and the **direction in which the defence is facing**, depending on the position of the ball and the goal being defended.

The most common systems are **1-2-2**, **1-1-2-1**, and **1-1-3**, as well as **specific systems for situations when outnumbered by the opposition (4v5 and 3v4)**.

1.2.5.3 Defensive transition

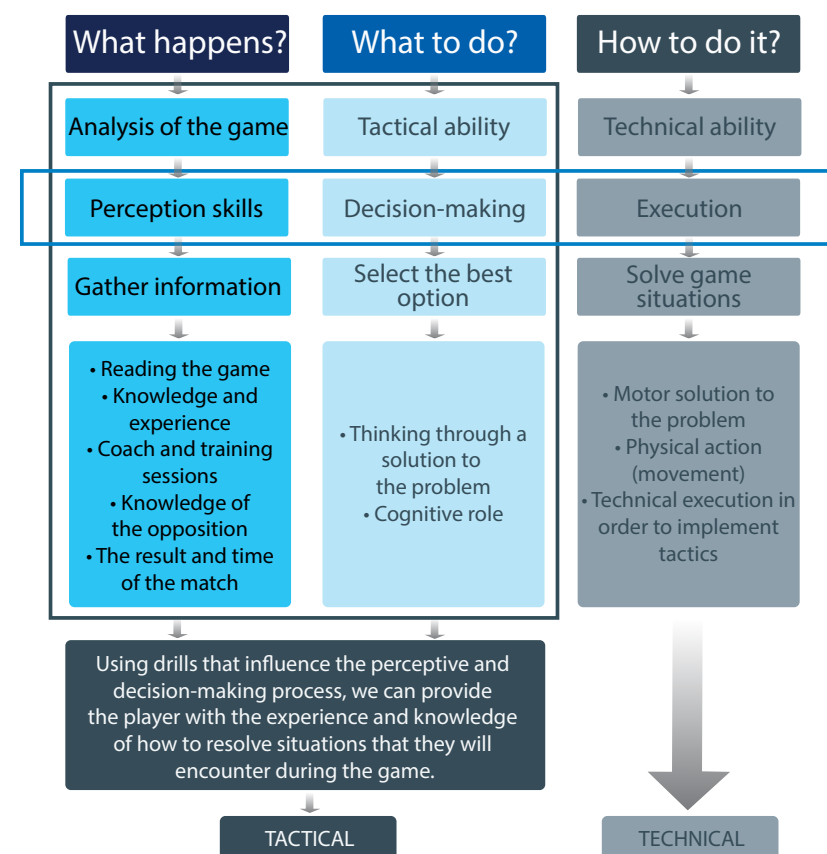
As we have already seen, the defensive transition begins at the moment in which possession is lost and includes several different phases: balance, buying time and dropping back, prior to which the whole team gets behind the ball and begins to prepare itself for positional defending. The aim of the defensive transition is to prevent the opposition from launching a quick attack before the team has organised itself defensively, and to recover the positions vacated on pushing forward in an organised fashion so that the positional defence can be implemented.

1.2.6 The role of tactics in futsal

Mahlo's diagram (1969) sets out the various elements that are involved in tactics and how they can be broken down into three processes: perception, decision-making and execution.

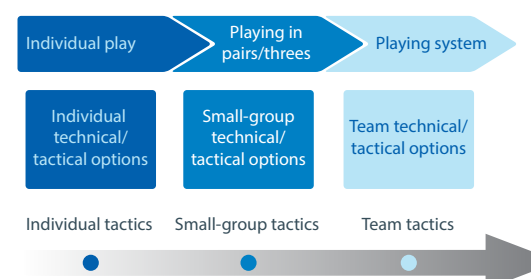
1. **Perception:** this is the starting point and the basis for any tactical element, particularly in a sport, such as futsal, that is founded on teamwork and opposition, which makes the decision-making process more complicated.
2. **Decision-making:** once we have evaluated the situation, we need to make the correct decision and provide the most effective solution in light of the game situation and the speed of the game. Making correct decisions means selecting the most effective solution to the problems encountered during a game. The first two processes involve a tactical component – we make correct decisions by accurately analysing the game, based on accurate and comprehensive information.
3. **Execution:** the process of putting the intended motor actions into practice. Conditional factors can have an impact on this process, as can the individual's technical ability to find a motor solution to the problem.

The role of tactics



1.2.7 Categorising tactics

Tactics can be categorised according to the number of players involved:



By **individual tactics** we mean a group of actions made by a player based on their knowledge and on core individual tactical concepts. **Small-group tactics** broaden the framework of knowledge and tactical concepts through the relationship between the player and the ball, their team-mates and opponents. **Team tactics** refer to the model of play adopted by all of the players together (i.e. the whole team).

1.2.8 Methods for coaching tactics

1.2.8.1 Cognitive model and decision-making

Should we organise an instructed, targeted training session, in which execution drills are repeated over and over and the player performs actions without thinking or analysing the game?

Or

Is a global and integrated training session more suitable? This type of session continues to focus on execution but adapts to the internal logic of the game and shapes the player's perceptive and decision-making mechanisms, enhancing their creativity.

Do we want a player with a narrow range of tactical experiences who needs to seek direction from the bench in order to make decisions?

Or

Do we want a player who is capable of reading the game and making decisions on the basis of what they have learned?

Traditional model: work on the separate training components (technical, tactical, physical preparation, etc).

Cognitive model: training which combines and integrates all of the components based on real game play.

Because

- Futsal is a game which presents tactical challenges.
- Actions are never executed without a specific motive relating to the game and its internal logic.
- Futsal requires cognitive ability, rather than the ability to simply reproduce actions mechanically.

Why

- To adapt to the variations and open-ended situations that the game presents.
- To develop players who are capable of focusing their attention on what is relevant in every action.
- To enable players to think their actions through during the game and improve their creative skills.

Methodological recommendations

- Teaching techniques should predominantly comprise active methods. By not providing the players with all of the information, they are left to discover it for themselves.
- Training should be based on real game play, with drills that allow for open solutions.
- Players should be encouraged to think for themselves at all times.